



The Garamut “The message sender”

Ps Barry Reflections from ‘The WORD’!

**For PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION &
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions

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REFLECTIONS

OUR THEME: I SAT WHERE THEY SAT

Our text: Ezekiel 3:15 *Then I came to them of the captivity at Tel-abib, that dwelt by the river of Chebar, and I sat where they sat, and remained there astonished among them seven days. KJV.*

Ezekiel 3:15 Then I came to them of the captivity at Tel-abib, who sat and dwelt by the river of Chebar, and I sat where they sat and remained there among them seven days, overwhelmed with astonishment and silent. AMP

Ezekiel 3:15 Then I came to them of the captivity at Tel-abib, that dwelt by the river of Kebar, and I sat where they sat, and remained there astonished among them seven days. Webster

Ezekiel 3:14-15 The Spirit lifted me up, and took me away to Tel Abib, another colony of Jewish exiles beside the Chebar River. I went in bitterness and anger, but the hand of the Lord was strong upon me. And I sat among them, overwhelmed, for seven days. TLB

My reflections

I was challenged with this phrase ‘I sat where they sat’ because it spoke to me about my care and concern and identifying with people’s sufferings and distress in a world that seems to be struggling with compassion, fatigue, there are so many tragedies and sorrows happening every day and we are flooded by the news and multimedia to the point that there is a real tendency to turn oneself off.

And this is so easy to do – where we as Christians can be affected to the extent that our capacity for empathy, caring and concern for people’s predicament is gradually decreasing, fading, or weakening.

So it was in this area that I was again challenged as to my willingness to identify with people’s needs - Was I prepared to sit where they sat – prepared to come down and show empathy towards them – taking time to listen to their story and predicament?

So that’s the message of my reflection today, that we be reminded of the need to continue to maintain our compassion and empathy for others and emulate what God did in LIFTING Us UP out of a horrible pit of sin and degradation as a result of Christ’s condescension (coming down) and identifying with us.

Psalms 40:2 He brought me up also out of an horrible pit, Out of the miry clay, And set my feet upon a rock, And established my goings. KJV

Psalms 40:2 He drew me up from the pit of destruction, out of the miry bog, and set my feet upon a rock, making my steps secure. ESV

1. CHRIST’S GENTLENESS MADE US GREAT

His gentleness – his coming (STOOPING) down – made us to be someone that has Identity, Worth and Value.

*2 Samuel 22:36 And thou didst give me the shield of thy salvation, and **THY CONDESCENDING GENTLENESS** hath made me great. Darby*

*2 Samuel 22:36 You have also given me the shield of Your salvation; and **YOUR CONDESCENSION AND GENTLENESS** have made me great. AMP*

*2 Samuel 22:36 And Thou givest to me the shield of Thy salvation, and **THY LOWLINESS** maketh me great. YLT*

- **STOOPING** by implication means humility - humbling of self.

2. **CARRYING THE BURDENS OF OTHERS – IDENTIFYING with their troubles and difficulties - Galatians 6:2.**

Galatians 6:2 Bear (endure, carry) one another's burdens and troublesome moral faults, and in this way fulfill and observe perfectly the law of Christ (the Messiah) and complete what is lacking [in your obedience to it]. AMP

Galatians 6:2 Carry each other's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ. NIV

Galatians 6:2 Bear ye one another's burdens and so fulfil the law of Christ. KJV

- WE ALSO NEED TO **STOOP DOWN – TO COME DOWN** TO MEET THEM IN THEIR NEED SO THAT WE CAN LIFT THEM UP.

*Galatians 6:2 **Stoop down** and reach out to those who are oppressed. Share their burdens, and so complete Christ's law. THE MESSAGE*

3. **THE IMPORTANCE OF HAVING EMPATHY AND IDENTIFYING WITH OTHER PEOPLE'S SUFFERINGS.**

Romans 12:15: "Rejoice with those who rejoice; weep with those who weep.

- " **THIS IS ABOUT SHOWING EMPATHY AND IDENTIFYING WITH WHAT OTHERS ARE EXPERIENCING IN THEIR LIVES.**

1 Corinthians 12:26: "If one part suffers, every part suffers with it; if one part is honoured, every part rejoices with it."

- **REMEMBERING ALL OF GOD'S CHILDREN ARE CONNECTED AND AFFECTED WITH THE SUFFERING AND SORROWS OF OTHERS.**

Hebrews 13:3 Don't forget about those in jail. Suffer with them as though you were there yourself. Share the sorrow of those being mistreated, for you know what they are going through. TLB

Hebrews 13:3 Remember those in prison, as if you were there yourself. Remember also those being mistreated, as if you felt their pain in your own bodies. NLT

- **SHARING THE SORROW OF OTHERS BEING MISTREATED AS IF YOU WERE WITH THEM**

Hebrews 4:15: "For we do not have a high priest who is unable to sympathize with our weaknesses, but we have one who has been tempted in every way, just as we are—yet was without sin."

- **THIS SHOWS JESUS CHRIST IDENTIFYING PERFECTLY WITH HUMANITY'S FRAILTIES AND TRIALS.**

Nehemiah 1:4 Nehemiah's Prayer: As soon as I heard these words I sat down and wept and mourned for days, and I continued fasting and praying before the God of heaven. ESV

- **WHEN NEHEMIAH HEARD ABOUT THE DEVASTATION IN JERUSALEM, HE WAS NOT REMOVED FROM IT BUT SAT DOWN, WEPT, MOURNED, AND FASTED. HE FULLY IMMERSSED HIMSELF IN THE DISTRESS OF HIS EXILED PEOPLE.**

4. **THE GOOD SAMARITAN - CAME WHERE HE WAS**

*Luke 10:33 But a certain Samaritan, as he journeyed, **came where he was**: and when he saw him, he had compassion on him. KJV*

Luke 10:33 33 But a Samaritan, as he travelled, came where the man was; and when he saw him, he took pity on him. NIV

- **WHICH MEANS THAT THE SAMARITAN BECAUSE OF COMPASSION IDENTIFIED WITH THE WOUNDED MAN'S NEEDS.**

HE CAME DOWN

*Luke 10:33 But a certain Samaritan, as he travelled along, **came down** to where he was; and when he saw him, he was moved with pity and sympathy [for him], AMP*

THERE ARE SOME OCCASIONS WHEN WE HAVE TO COME DOWN FROM VARIOUS OPINIONS AND PREFERENCES THAT WE MAY HOLD, ALL FOR THE BENEFIT OF PEOPLE.

CONCLUSION

- **THE CHALLENGE FOR EACH OF US IS TO DO THOSE THINGS THAT FEED AND STIMULATES THE CONTINUED PRESENCE OF COMPASSION IN OUR LIVES AND OUR WILLINGNESS TO COME DOWN - TO STOOP – TO IDENTIFY WITH PEOPLE'S CIRCUMSTANCES.**

- **NOT BEING TEMPTED TO REJOICE AT THE FALL OR SORROW OF OTHERS.**

Micah 7:8 Do not be glad because of my sorrow, O my hater: after my fall I will be lifted up; when I am seated in the dark, the Lord will be a light to me. BBE

- **A WILLINGNESS TO HEAR THEIR STORY, SHOWING EMPATHY AND COMPASSION – NOT JUDGING – BUT LIFTING THEM UP WITH HOPE FOR A BETTER FUTURE.**

AMEN - Ps Barry